

3.1.1 Area of study 1: Western classical tradition 1650–1910 (compulsory)

For the purposes of this specification, the western classical tradition is defined as art music of (or growing out of) the European tradition, normally notated, and normally intended for public performance.

There are **three** strands of music represented which cover **three** key genres:

- Baroque: the solo concerto
- Classical: the operas of Mozart
- Romantic: the piano music of Chopin, Brahms and Grieg.

Listening – unfamiliar music

Students must be able to listen attentively to unfamiliar music from each of the **three** strands to identify and accurately describe musical elements and use musical language (including staff notation).

Analysis and contextual understanding – set works

For **two** of the selected strands, students must also be able to critically appraise music through analysing excerpts from the set works using knowledge and understanding of:

- the effect of audience, time and place on how the set works were created, developed and performed
- how and why the music across the selected strand is different
- how the composer's purpose and intention for the set works is reflected in their use of musical elements
- relevant musical vocabulary and terminology for the set works
- the complex interdependencies between musical elements
- the sophisticated connections between music and its context.

Strand A: Baroque solo concerto

Composer	Set works
Purcell	Sonata for trumpet and strings in D major Z.850 (complete)
Vivaldi	Flute concerto in D <i>Il Gardellino</i> op.10 no.3 RV428 (complete)
Bach	Violin concerto in A minor BWV1041 (complete)

Strand B: The operas of Mozart

Composer	Set works
Mozart	<i>Le Nozze di Figaro</i> k.492: Act 1, focusing on: • overture • No.1 Duetto (Figaro and Susanna, including following recitative) • No.3 Cavatina (Figaro, including the previous recitative) • No.4 Aria (Bartolo) • No.5 Duetto (Susanna and Marcellina) • No.6 Aria (Cherubino) • No.7 Terzetto (Susanna, Basilio, Count) • No.9 Aria (Figaro).

Strand C: The piano music of Chopin, Brahms and Grieg

Composer	Set works
Chopin	• Ballade no.2 in F major op. 38 • Nocturne in E minor op.72 no.1
Brahms	• Intermezzo in A major op.118.no. 2 • Ballade in G minor op.118 no. 3
Grieg	• Norwegian march op.54 no. 2 • Notturmo op.54 no. 4

The edition and any translation used are at the discretion of the teacher and student. However we will name the editions used for the exam at aqa.org.uk/music.

Musical elements

Students must be able to use knowledge and understanding of the following musical elements when appraising music from this Area of study.

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand, to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section B (Analysis and Contextual understanding) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section B (Analysis and Contextual understanding) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• contour – ascending, descending, stepwise, conjunct, disjunct, scalar, triadic and arpeggio • intervals, including compound intervals • phrase length – equal, unequal and balanced • ornaments – trill, mordent, turn, acciaccatura and appoggiatura • passing notes – accented, unaccented and chromatic • auxiliary notes – upper, lower and chromatic • note of anticipation • échappée note • portamento • melodic devices – sequence, motif, fragmentation, repetition, intervallic augmentation and diminution.

Element type	Element
Harmony	• consonant and dissonant • diatonic – primary and secondary triads, dominant 7th and all inversions • chromatic – diminished 7th, secondary dominant 7th, substitution chords (borrowing from opposite mode), chord of the Neapolitan, Neapolitan 6th and augmented 6th chords (Italian, German, French) • cadences – perfect, imperfect, interrupted, plagal, half close, phrygian and tierce de Picardie • circle of 5^{ths} progression, harmonic sequence • pedal notes – tonic, dominant, inverted and inner • suspensions (4–3, 7–6, 9–8 and bass), preparation and resolution • cadential 6/4.
Tonality	• major, minor, and their key signatures • modulation to dominant, subdominant, and their relatives, also to tonic minor, relative minor and tertiary keys • enharmonic keys • modality.
Structure	• binary, rounded binary and ternary • ritornello and episode • sonata form • through-composed • introduction and coda • recitative and aria • foursquare • antecedent and consequent phrases • ostinato.
Sonority (Timbre)	• standard orchestral and vocal types • basso continuo • pizzicato, arco, col legno, con sordino, sul ponticello, sul tasto and double stopping • sotto voce, vibrato • una corda, pedalling.

Element type	Element
Texture	• solo, monophonic, unison, octaves, parallel 3rds • melody and accompaniment, homophonic, chordal • polyphonic, contrapuntal, imitative, fugal • antiphonal • trio sonata texture • polarised • counter melody, descant • canon.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• simple and compound time • common Italian tempo terms including <i>ritenuto</i>, <i>rallentando</i> and <i>accelerando</i> • <i>rubato</i>, pause • syncopation, hemiola, cross-rhythm, motor-rhythm.
Dynamics and articulation	• common Italian dynamic terms including <i>sfz</i> and <i>fp</i> • accent, tenuto, staccato, marcato, legato.

Musical language

Students must be able to use musical language appropriate to this Area of study in the following ways:

Reading staff notation

Students must be able to identify musical elements (as above) when reading staff notation.

For unfamiliar music, students must be able to read short passages of a minimum of four bars and a maximum of eight bars.

For familiar music, students must be able to read approximately two pages of music score.

Writing staff notation

Students must be able to:

- write melodic notation in all keys within short passages of music of a minimum of four bars and a maximum of eight bars
- write rhythmic notation, including compound time within short passages of a minimum of four bars and a maximum of eight bars.

Chords

Students must learn standard and extended chords, including chord inversions and secondary dominant 7^{ths}, and be able to identify them in aural and written form. Examples of relevant types of chords can be found in the [Musical elements](#) (page 13).

Musical vocabulary and terminology

Students must be able to identify and apply appropriate musical vocabulary and terminology to both music heard and notated. The appropriate vocabulary and terminology required can be found in the tables appropriate to the student's selected area of study.